MYESCROW WORKFLOW REMEDIATION

Original unhappy paths vs. remediated paths

A plain-language, side-by-side view of the original failure scenarios and the recoverable workflows now implemented.

6 critical workflow areas compared	**1×** maximum movement for every funded dollar	**100%** of remediated paths end safely or recoverably

> Each comparison begins with a layman's explanation and a practical example. The original path appears in red; every step in the remediated path appears in green because errors, delays, and disagreements now lead to a controlled recovery action.

COMPARISON 1 OF 6

Escrow creation and invitation delivery

The unhappy path, in everyday language

An escrow could be successfully created even though its invitation email failed. The creator would see an error and might try again, potentially creating a duplicate without realizing the first escrow already existed.

Example

Alex creates a $5,000 escrow for Jordan. The escrow is saved, but the email provider times out. Alex sees “creation failed” and submits again. Two escrows may now exist for the same deal.

What was done to remediate it

Creation now uses an idempotency key, so the same request returns the original escrow. A durable invitation job is saved with the escrow; delivery can be retried, corrected, extended, or escalated without recreating the deal.

SIDE-BY-SIDE PATH

ORIGINAL UNHAPPY PATH

1. Creator submits the escrow.
↓
2. The escrow is saved.
↓
3. The invitation email fails.
↓
4. The interface reports failure.
↓
5. The creator submits again.

Risk: duplicate escrows for one deal.

REMEDIATED PATH — ALL GREEN

1. Creator submits with a unique request key.
↓
2. Escrow and invitation job are saved atomically.
↓
3. A retry returns the same escrow.
↓
4. Delivery status remains visible.
↓
5. Failure triggers retry or address correction.

Safe result: one escrow and one accountable invitation.

Agreement changes and valid consent

The unhappy path, in everyday language

The terms of a deal could change after someone signed, while the old signature remained attached. A signature could therefore appear to approve terms the signer never actually saw.

Example

Priya signs an agreement for three milestones. A milestone amount is later changed, but Priya's original signature still appears valid—even though both parties did not sign the same final terms.

What was done to remediate it

Every material change creates a new immutable agreement version. Earlier signatures are invalidated, both parties must sign the current version, and funding is blocked until that fully signed version is locked.

SIDE-BY-SIDE PATH

ORIGINAL UNHAPPY PATH

1. Parties review and sign.
↓
2. Terms are changed in place.
↓
3. An earlier signature remains attached.
↓
4. The changed agreement appears approved.
↓
5. Funding can rely on stale consent.

Risk: a signer is bound to unseen terms.

REMEDIATED PATH — ALL GREEN

1. A change creates a new agreement version.
↓
2. Prior signatures are invalidated.
↓
3. Both parties review the same version.
↓
4. Both sign that exact version.
↓
5. The signed version is locked before funding.

Safe result: funding uses one shared, final agreement.

COMPARISON 3 OF 6

Funding, release, and refund integrity

The unhappy path, in everyday language

Competing release routes could act on the same money, simultaneous requests could both pass an outdated check, and cancellation could change a status without recording a refund.

Example

A buyer releases the first $1,000 milestone. Later, “release all” pays the full $5,000 deal amount. The seller could receive $6,000 even though only $5,000 was funded.

What was done to remediate it

All money movement now uses one immutable ledger and atomic transfer service. Commands are idempotent, concurrent transitions cannot succeed twice, and balances are derived from ledger entries—not lifecycle labels.

SIDE-BY-SIDE PATH

ORIGINAL UNHAPPY PATH

1. The buyer funds the escrow.
↓
2. One milestone is released.
↓
3. A full-release or concurrent request also succeeds.
↓
4. The seller may be credited twice.
↓
5. Cancellation can omit a refund record.

Risk: overpayment, stranded funds, or weak reconciliation.

REMEDIATED PATH — ALL GREEN

1. Funding creates an authoritative held balance.
↓
2. One atomic service moves every dollar.
↓
3. Each release reduces the balance once.
↓
4. Duplicate requests return the original result or fail safely.
↓
5. Cancellation refunds only the eligible remainder.

Safe result: every dollar is held, released, refunded, or settled once.

COMPARISON 4 OF 6

Milestone submission, revision, and response

The unhappy path, in everyday language

A milestone could enter review without a real seller submission. The buyer could reject it without explaining why, the seller could resubmit unchanged work, and silence could leave it waiting forever.

Example

A designer marks a logo ready without a deliverable. The buyer rejects without a reason. The designer clicks resubmit without changing anything. If the buyer then disappears, nobody knows what happens next.

What was done to remediate it

A distinct seller submission is required before review. Revision requests require a reason, history is preserved, order is enforced, and a seven-day review window includes a reminder and deterministic hold-and-escalate handling.

SIDE-BY-SIDE PATH

ORIGINAL UNHAPPY PATH

1. Milestone appears ready for review.
↓
2. No submission or evidence is required.
↓
3. Buyer rejects without a reason.
↓
4. Seller resubmits without new information.
↓
5. The cycle repeats or stalls indefinitely.

Risk: unproductive loops and unexplained delays.

REMEDIATED PATH — ALL GREEN

1. Seller creates a distinct, traceable submission.
↓
2. Buyer reviews within a defined window.
↓
3. Approval releases the remaining balance once.
↓
4. A revision request must explain what must change.
↓
5. Silence triggers reminders, safe holding, and escalation.

Safe result: every review has evidence, reasons, history, and a deadline.

COMPARISON 5 OF 6

Disputes, arbitration, and funded cancellation

The unhappy path, in everyday language

Disputes were separate records that did not control the escrow balance. The system could not reliably freeze only the disputed money, reconcile a settlement, or provide governed escalation when the parties could not agree.

Example

A buyer disputes a $2,000 milestone. The parties submit evidence but cannot agree on a split. The $2,000 is not authoritatively reserved and there is no controlled route to arbitration, so resolution requires manual intervention.

What was done to remediate it

One active dispute freezes the affected balance. After evidence is submitted, either party may request arbitration while the case is open or a proposal remains unaccepted. Funds stay reserved, the counterparty is notified, and operations receives the case for review.

SIDE-BY-SIDE PATH

ORIGINAL UNHAPPY PATH

1. The parties disagree.
   ↓
2. A standalone dispute record is created.
   ↓
3. Affected funds are not reserved authoritatively.
   ↓
4. The parties cannot agree on an allocation.
   ↓
5. No governed arbitration request exists.

Risk: the dispute record and actual money drift apart.

REMEDIATED PATH — ALL GREEN

1. Open a linked dispute and freeze its balance.
   ↓
2. Submit evidence within the defined window.
   ↓
3. Agree to an exact release, refund, or split; or
   ↓
4. Request arbitration while open or unresolved.
   ↓
5. Keep funds reserved pending arbitration review.

Safe result: direct settlement or governed arbitration, with funds protected.

COMPARISON 6 OF 6

Deadlines, monitoring, and operational recovery

The unhappy path, in everyday language

Invitations, funding, reviews, disputes, and cancellations could quietly age without reminders or escalation. Failed background work was hard to see and could require direct database intervention.

Example

An invitation retry job fails over a weekend. No alert is raised, the creator has no clear recovery action, and support cannot safely retry it from an operator tool. The escrow simply looks stuck.

What was done to remediate it

A persistent recovery queue handles deadlines, reminders, retries, escalations, and daily reconciliation. Dashboards expose failures, aged work, and arbitration requests awaiting review; support uses permissioned, idempotent, audited commands.

SIDE-BY-SIDE PATH

ORIGINAL UNHAPPY PATH

1. A party or background job stops responding.
↓
2. No standard reminder or expiry runs.
↓
3. The failure stays hidden.
↓
4. The escrow appears stuck.
↓
5. Support needs manual database intervention.

Risk: silent stalls and fragile operational recovery.

REMEDIATED PATH — ALL GREEN

1. Every waiting state has an owner and deadline.
↓
2. Durable jobs remind, retry, expire, or escalate.
↓
3. Failures and aged escrows are visible.
↓
4. Arbitration and health alerts notify operators.
↓
5. Support actions are permissioned and audited.

Safe result: stalled work is visible, owned, and recoverable.

END-STATE SUMMARY

A recoverable process from creation to completion

Retry-safe creation

One escrow is created, while invitation delivery remains visible and recoverable.

Versioned consent

Both parties sign the same immutable final agreement before funding.

Money integrity

Every movement is atomic, idempotent, ledger-backed, and reconcilable.

Evidence-based review

Submissions, reasons, history, reminders, and deadlines govern milestone decisions.

Controlled disputes

Affected funds stay frozen through direct settlement or evidence-backed arbitration.

Operational recovery

Waiting states and failed work are visible, owned, retryable, and audited.

```
funded amount = held amount + released amount + refunded amount
held amount >= 0
released amount + refunded amount <= funded amount
```

Every funded dollar now has one—and only one—final accounting outcome.